CHAPTER FOUR

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT AND THE GLOBAL SOUTH

Learning Objectives:

After studying this chapter, the students will be able to:

1. Define development and identify its four paradigms and dimensions.

2. Examine the agenda of Sustainable Development Goals, its implementation, and criticisms.

3. Analyze the issues and challenges of the global south and how they relate to globalization.

4. Criticize the different tools in development by assessing global programs and experiences in the Global South

Introduction

The earliest development of the European economy during the Industrial Revolution could be attributed to Europe's vast availability of resources. Its demographic and geographic setup had a number of advantages like improved food production and enhancement of technology. The success of Europe in technology, markets, innovation, and specialization adversely affected the transactions and exchanges of goods, commodities, and services. Efficiency became an obvious result of this trend making people less participative in the operation of businesses and economic organizations. It has developed and introduced more complex norms of interactions between and among people and institutions thus, making Europe a backbone of global order and development. Why did such a condition happen in Europe? Why have European countries developed faster than other countries and regions in the world?

The number of advantages brought by this European phenomenon provides opportunities to countries that have dependence on the rest of the world especially to EU and the United States. Opening the local market to other economies is aimed to enhance the competitiveness of the domestic market thus, generating new avenues for development. Stable economies are often the beneficiaries of globalization. These economies are more active and have the higher capability to compete head-to-head with developing and developed countries. Liberals argue that if countries will just only take part in the global phenomenon of political and economic interconnectedness, they will benefit from the different opportunities offered by globalization. The underlying problem with globalization as far as development is concerned is its uneven impact on all players.

Developed and middle-income economies have the highest global share in terms of wealth brought by globalization.

This chapter presents issues and challenges of global development, the problems faced by developing and poor economies as well as countries within the global south.

1. DEFINITION OF DEVELOPMENT

The term development is described as a process, system, or procedure. It is a state or condition of changing and enhancing something. Oxford defines development as *"a process and an event constituting a new stage in a changing situation"*. This process requires a number of factors and considerations in developing a part of its system or constituent elements. Development is a complex and multidimensional concept occurring in an uncertain condition. Bellù (2011), stresses that the development of the other parts of the system could be detrimental to the development of the other thus creating structural and systemic conflicts. The current trend of global economic development is multidimensional in practice; it has come into contact with the rise and emergence of other social constituents. The economic globalization phenomenon as the main frontline of the post-modernity era is viewed as the major force in the birth of political and ethnological developments. However, liberalism pointed out that the current face of global development in terms of economic development is enjoyed only among the core countries in the West.

Critics of global development assert that countries do not equally get the gains of globalization. Countries that lack resources and infrastructures are at the bottom part of the phenomenon where the benefits are unequally distributed worldwide. The disparity is very evident between rich and poor countries. CSOs describe this situation as maldevelopment, a condition where developing and less developed countries suffer from the downside effects of development and changes. This kind of situation usually happens in an economy that is too liberal in its practice of opening the local economy to foreign markets.

2. DIMENSIONS OF DEVELOPMENT

The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations has enumerated the four dimensions and prevailing paradigms of development.

Economic Development

This dimension of development is traditionally viewed as conflated with economic growth. Lucas (1988) and Fieldman, et al (2016) contend that economic growth and economic development are distinct fields. Growth as a theory is easily quantified and measured like the increase of production in labor, machinery, and capital. On the other hand, economic development is focused on the qualitative aspect of change that sometimes people fail to determine like the increased quality of life, social improvements, and innovations. Sen (1999) defined economic development

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as “the expansion of capacities that contribute to the advancement of society through the realization of individuals’, firms’, and communities’ potential”. It is associated with the full participation of economic agents given the freedom to develop all capacities as part of developing the economy. The more individuals involved in the operation of the economy the higher the level of expected development. Economic development as a transformation requires altering some fundamental economic structures, increasing the occupational capacities of the population, and empowering the mobility of key economic agents.

Human Development

Human development is complemented by a number of underlying frameworks and motivations. In its 2016 Human Development Report, UNDP has outlined the three dimensions of human development namely 1) a long and healthy life; 2) knowledge; and 3) a decent standard of living. Indicators utilized in this report were life expectancy at birth, expected and mean years of schooling, and Gross National Income (GNI) per capita. This Human Development Index was created to emphasize that economic growth should be used as a criterion in assessing the development of a particular country but the development of the people and their capabilities. This report was a response to the growing disparity between the poor and rich where poverty has become a major challenge to governments as part of its national policy making. The global problem of poverty has brought attention to how countries and key institutions will combat its war on poverty and hunger.

Territorial Development

This dimension of development focuses on the interrelationships of human activities between rural and urban areas (Bellù, 2011). Social activities of man as part of territorial development include the production, distribution, and consumption of goods and services, the balance and quality features of its norms and practices that support the operation of man’s social affairs. Territorial development is composed of clusters that link activities and structures. Critical to this development is how clusters and agencies respond to the challenges of resource scarcity which are then interlinked to problems like food security, space availability, and overcrowding. The development process of this dimension operates on both national and transnational scope.

Sustainable Development

This dimension of development is defined by the Bruntland Commission formerly known as the World Commission on Environment and Development (WCED) as “development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs." The concept of sustainable development has drawn several interpretations and notions of development in the age of uncertainty and massive environmental alterations. It has affirmed that development is a need and it must be observed and practiced based on the necessity of man and his environment. However, development efforts and practices must be in accordance with the harmony of nature without compromising the ecological condition and future generations. This

framework is considered the foundational guideline of international cooperation of member countries, conveners, and key institutions behind the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) of the United Nations.

From the lens of economist Paul Streeten (1991) and Gulet (2000), the concept of sustainable development is built on six different definitions.

1. The maintenance and replacement of capital assets
2. Maintaining the environmental conditions for the benefit of all
3. Resiliency or the ability to adjust and cope with the changes and crises
4. The avoidance of internal and external debts in the future
5. Fiscal and political sustainability
6. The ability to hand over programs and projects to the decision and control of the citizens.

3. SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS (SDGs)

Sustainable Development Goals or Global Goals were established as part of the success of the Millennium Development Goals of 2015. In the next fifteen years, member countries of the UN, rich or poor, developed or developing are expected to mobilize all efforts to end the global problem of poverty, solve inequality, and address the impacts of climate change.

Parties involved in the global war on poverty believe that more active participation and a higher level of commitment are necessary to materialize SDGs by 2030. This global partnership among states is not binding however, national governments have the ownership and authority to make and implement national policies that are in line with the objectives of SDGs. These policies are of high quality and have accessibility to the public and other concerned bodies as a mechanism for delivering relevant works and outputs.

The General Assembly adopted the 17 Sustainable Development Goals as part of the agency's flagship goal 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. These 17 goals are built on the mantra of 'leaving no one behind".

3.1. 17 Sustainable Development Goals

Goal 1. End poverty in all its forms everywhere.

Goal 2. End hunger achieve food security and improved nutrition and promote sustainable agriculture.

Goal 3. Ensure healthy lives and promote well-being for all at all ages.

Goal 4. Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote.

Goal 5. Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls.

Goal 6. Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all.

Goal 7. Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable, and modern energy for all.

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Goal 8. Promote sustained, inclusive, and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment, and decent work for all.

Goal 9. Build resilient infrastructure, promote inclusive and sustainable industrialization, and foster innovation

Goal 10. Reduce inequality within and among countries.

Goal 11. Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient, and sustainable.

Goal 12. Ensure sustainable consumption and production patterns

Goal 13. Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts

Goal 14. Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas, and marine resources for sustainable development

Goal 15. Protect, restore, and promote sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, sustainably manage forests, combat desertification, halt and reverse land degradation, and halt biodiversity loss.

Goal 16. Promote peaceful and inclusive societies for sustainable development, provide access to justice for all, and build effective, accountable, and inclusive institutions at all levels.

Goal 17. Strengthen the means of implementation and revitalize the Global Partnership for Sustainable Development.

United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Image source: United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs

4. IMPLEMENTATION OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS (SDGs)

The Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development came up with the following actions on the implementation of SDGs

a. The success of policies and programs of SDGs relies on the actions and willingness of members- parties and states to align their plans with the kind of global commitments. Plans initiated and implemented at the national level are gauges of how governments respond to the demands of SDGs. These national policies are used as barometers in monitoring the progress of the goals especially at the local and national levels where problems and issues exist.

b. Resource mobilization and financing strategies are fundamental requirements in materializing nationally-framed and locally-led sustainable development goals. Resources like manpower, capital, logistics, and key infrastructures are significant in the timely and responsive delivery of solutions to global concerns.

c. The expected contribution of governments, the private sector, civil society groups, and other stakeholders of the SDGs. The roles of NGOs and CSOs are potentially advantageous in the attainment of SDGs. These private entities and organizations perform tasks where governments fail to act and deliver. The lack of governmental actions on a particular issue and problem is being filled by the presence of NGOs and concerned parties.

d. The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development requires a partnership between the efforts of the global community and national government. Global governance is the main driver of achieving SDGs with the cooperation of national governments who have commitments and responsibilities to this agenda. This partnership requires fundamental institutional support from all leading government agencies that have the resources and will in the materialization of the 17 goals.

4.1. Criticisms on SDGs

Concerns have been found on SDGs as it was described as highly demanding and transformational in several ways:

1. Far wider scope. There are only 34 out of 169 targets from the 17 goals are quantifiable

2. Going for 'zero'. Reduction efforts should be replaced by total elimination of the problem of poverty and unemployment

3. Universality: Since this is a global goal, every nation, including the richest and developing economies, must make its own targets and agenda.

4. Leave no one behind: aside from inequality, attention should be given too to other global concerns.

5. High focus on sustainable development of air, consumption, and environmental problems

6. Invest efforts in peace and security and the rule of law.

7. A balance of responsibilities. Intensify domestic policies with the support of international bodies.

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Different Regional takes on the Top Three SDGs

China	India	South-East Asia and Australia	MENA	Sub-Saharan Africa	Europe	North America	Latin America
15. Life on Land	2. Zero Hunger	8. Decent Work and Economic Growth	6. Clean water and Sanitation	1. No Poverty	8. Decent Work and Economic Growth	8. Decent Work and Economic Growth	8. Decent Work and Economic Growth
16. Peace, Justice , and Strong Institution	1. No Poverty	9. Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructu re	3. Good Health and Well-Being	2. Zero Hunger	3. Good Health and Well-Being	3. Good Health and Well-Being	4. Quality education
7. Affordable and Clean Energy	8. Decent Work and Economic Growth	3. Good Health and Well- Being	2. Zero Hunger	8. Decent Work and Economic Growth	7. Affordable and Clean Energy	7. Affordable and Clean Energy	15. Life on Land

Source: UN Sustainable Development Goals

5. THE GLOBAL SOUTH

The moment you ask people what is meant by global south, many would probably have an unclear idea. The term could be associated with Africa, South America, or even countries within South Asia. It could be described too as part of economic status like a third-world country. In academic settings, the term global south is widely used in social sciences like sociology, political science, and economics. It is a major subject of discourse especially topics concerning globalization, the global divide, and uneven development across the globe. But what is this term? Many are confused about what it refers to.

South has a geographical connotation described as largely equivalent, but not identical to 'Third World' (Pagel et al., 2014). However, the term south does not refer to countries outside the United States and Europe, Australia and New Zealand do not belong to the "South". There is also an explanation of the term that it refers to countries that are excluded if not deprived of socioeconomic prominence and reputation like Africa, the Middle East, South America, South Asia, and countries within the Pacific. The inequalities and global divide between the rich and poor countries are part of globalization and territorializing is also part of the reality of the global south (Lopez, 2007).

Map of Global South with countries in color black belong to Global North. Image source: The Global South: Theories, Narratives, Spaces and Technologies, The Academy of Global Humanities and Critical Theory

The idea of a global south is a contemporary issue in the socioeconomic and political divide. Countries like the United States, Canada, outermost and western parts of Europe, Japan, Australia, and New Zealand are giant economies parts of the global north. These countries are described as highly industrialized, developed, and most advanced economies in the world. It rests on the fact that the entire world's industrially developed countries (except for Australia and New Zealand) lie to the north of its developing countries.

The following are lists of countries per region consisting of the global south. This listing was officially produced by the United Nations Development Program (UNDP)

AFRICA: Angola, Benin, Botswana, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Cape Verde, Central African Republic, Chad, Comoros, Congo, Cote d'Ivoire, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Djibouti, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea- Bissau, Kenya, Lesotho, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mauritius, Mozambique, Namibia, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Sao Tome and Principe, Senegal, Seychelles, Sierra Leone, Somalia, South Africa, Swaziland, Togo, Uganda, United Republic of Tanzania, Zambia, Zimbabwe

North Africa: Algeria, Egypt, Libyan Arab Jamahiriya, Morocco, Sudan, Tunisia.

ASIA: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, China, India, Indonesia, Democratic Peoples' Republic of Korea, Republic of Korea, Lao Peoples' Democratic Republic, Malaysia, Maldives, Mongolia, Myanmar, Nepal, Pakistan, Philippines, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Timor Leste, Viet Nam

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Central Asia: Armenia, Azerbaijan Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan

West Asia: Bahrain, Cyprus, Islamic Republic of Iran, Iraq, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syrian Arab Republic, Turkey, United Arab Emirates, Yemen

Pacific Islands: Federated States of Micronesia, Fiji, Kiribati, Marshall Islands, Nauru, Palau, Papua New Guinea, Samoa, Solomon Islands, Tuvalu, Vanuatu

Countries belonging to the global south possess various political and economic descriptions and experiences. In Africa, debts, poor infrastructure, education, employment, healthcare, and peace and security are key impediments. The region's problem with poverty is the fundamental challenge of governments and institutions providing key support to these countries.

Asian countries are found to be a combination of emerging and developing economies except for Singapore. Domestic and regional problems like unstable governments, rule of law, and environmental pollution are continuously at the frontline of concerns in the region. Central Asia on the other hand consists of countries that have experienced transitioning governments. These are former territories of the Soviet Union and stabilizing the economy brought by the damage of the former communist Soviet regime is still evident. Political and economic reforms are insufficient to address the fabric of communism during the Cold War era.

West Asian region has its unique social struggle. The region is confined to a costly conflict involving territorial insecurity, peace, and order, and competing extreme ideological clashes. Though the region is an oil-rich hub, but regional issues are barriers to the development process of West Asia.

Natural disasters and the absence of sufficient investment as a major source of the economy make countries in the Pacific Islands a victim of slow growth. Its economies are dependent on the influx of businesses and commercial activities from nearby countries in the Pacific as well as countries in Oceania, Asia, and America.

Countries belonging to Latin America are trapped in a turbulent economic environment. Regional matters like unstable democratic governance and fiscal problems are known challenges facing countries of the region. Latin and Caribbean countries are described as countries that have

experienced "lost development" because of missed economic opportunities, especially in the 60s and 70s.

5.1. Groups Defined by Economic Status of the Global South

20 Major Petroleum Exporters	Algeria, Angola, Bahrain, Brunei Darussalam, Congo, Gabon, Indonesia, Islamic Republic of Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Libyan Arab Jamahiriya, Nigeria, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syrian Arab Republic, Trinidad and Tobago, United Arab Emirates, Venezuela, Yemen
12 Major Exporters of Manufactures	Brazil, China, China (Taiwan Province), India, Malaysia, Mexico, Philippines, Republic of Korea, Singapore, South Africa, Thailand, Turkey.
42 Heavily Indebted Poor Countries	Angola, Benin, Bolivia, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Central African Republic, Chad, Comoros, Congo, Cote d'Ivoire, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Ethiopia, Ghana, Gambia, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Guyana, Honduras, Kenya, Lao People's Republic, Lesotho, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mozambique, Myanmar, Nicaragua, Niger, Rwanda, Sao Tome and Principe, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Somalia, Sudan, Togo, Uganda, United Republic of Tanzania, Viet Nam, Yemen, Zambia.
50 Least Developed Countries	Afghanistan, Angola, Bangladesh, Benin, Bhutan, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cambodia, Cape Verde, Central African Republic, Chad, Comoros, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Djibouti, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gambia, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Haiti, Kiribati, Lao Peoples' Republic, Lesotho, Liberia, Madagascar, Malawi, Maldives, Mali, Mauritania, Mozambique, Myanmar, Nepal, Niger, Rwanda, Samoa, Sao Tome and Principe, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Solomon Islands, Somalia, Sudan, Timor Leste, Togo, Tuvalu, Uganda, United Republic of Tanzania, Vanuatu, Yemen, Zambia.

30 Land Locked Countries	Afghanistan, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bhutan, Bolivia, Botswana, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Central African Republic, Chad, Ethiopia, Former Y ugoslav Republic of Macedonia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Lao Peoples' Republic, Lesotho, Malawi, Mali, Mongolia, Nepal, Niger, Paraguay, Rwanda, Swaziland, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Zambia, Zimbabwe.

Source: UNCTAD Handbook of Statistics 2002 and Forging a Global South Report of United Nations Development Programme.

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6. CAUSES OF GLOBAL DIVIDE

The following are some of the main factors causing the global divide between the north and south according to Balaam and Veseth (2008).

1. Globalization in the 1990

The economic intensification observed in the 90s fueled countries to establish boundaries. Poor countries that cannot cope with the demands of the rich and developed countries suffer most from the potential damage of globalization. Countries of the global south especially under unstable governments and weak economies failed to produce outputs as a response to the internationalization system of economy and government. There were countries that disappeared from the pipelines of global competition. Some countries mostly third world shifted their interest by relying on a more powerful economy.

2. Uneven Immigration.

The pattern of migration in the last three decades saw an unprecedented rise in migrant workers and citizens seeking greener opportunities in other countries. People from Asia targeted Western Europe and America as ideal points of employment. Developed countries that are at the height of technological development, advancement, and high-quality social services became the main venues for accepting migrants. This trend continues to happen in the current times where most countries of the global south found this opportunity as an alternative to the absence of jobs available in the local economy.

3. The hegemonic nature of international economic relations

The global problems of poverty and inequality are outcomes of the evil practices of Western countries. These problems are associated with the abuses of capitalists who control most of the world's wealth. International institutions that have the power and resources are very silent and unresponsive to these problems experienced by countries in the global south. Aginam (2000) echoed the sentiments of Mohamed Bedjaoui that the power of multinational corporations, structural inequality in the international monetary

system, and the heavy indebtedness of undeveloped countries are some of the chronic issues facing the international system. Countries in the global south are trapped in the hands of developed countries where rising financial obligations like loan programs are continuously punishing economies of the south.

6.1. Solving the Problem of Global South

The efforts of the UN in finding a solution to the longstanding problem of the global south prompted the agency to adopt a more cohesive and relevant policy. The Buenos Aires Plan of Action which was adopted during the Buenos Aires Conference put together a pool of industry experts, scholars, and key agencies around the world. A list of recommendations was set by the body to oversee and monitor the progress of the developmental agenda in countries of the global south.

1. Resources, capabilities, expertise, and information must be shared among developing economies in the global south. Middle-income and developing economies with sufficient resources and

expertise are ideal partners and references for reforms and initiatives of other economies under unstable development and risky growth.

2. These countries within the global south should strengthen their skills and knowledge, institutional arrangement and support, information sharing, and communication for the common good of all countries. Transnational linkages and exchanges of ideas and other resources among developing countries in the global south could accelerate development and changes in global problems.

3. Island developing, and locked and least developed countries should be given sufficient attention through the use of existing opportunities, partnerships, and resource sharing. Mobilization of resources could be pooled towards struggling economies of the global south. Attention with a focus on infrastructure and manpower development should be within the priorities of other countries that have the available support programs on the economic and political challenges of these countries.

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